Psychologist-Client Services Agreement and Informed Consent

Kate Shirley, Ph.D.
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This agreement explains my psychotherapy services, confidentiality, and practice policies. Please review it carefully and let me know if you have any questions before beginning treatment.

About My Practice

I earned my Ph.D. in Clinical Psychology from Oregon Health & Science University and completed my predoctoral internship and postdoctoral fellowship at Brown University. My clinical training includes behavioral medicine, health psychology, and psychotherapy in outpatient and medical settings.

I provide individual psychotherapy for adults experiencing psychological, emotional, relational, and health-related concerns. I also work with couples and families navigating complex medical conditions. My approach is collaborative and individualized, drawing from cognitive-behavioral, acceptance-based, interpersonal, and psychodynamic approaches.

The Psychotherapy Process

Psychotherapy begins with an initial assessment of your concerns, history, goals, and current circumstances. Together, we will consider what you hope to gain from treatment and develop an approach that fits your needs. Therapy may involve discussing difficult experiences, emotions, relationships, or patterns of behavior. Although psychotherapy can lead to meaningful improvements in well-being and functioning, it may also involve periods of discomfort, and specific outcomes cannot be guaranteed.

You have the right to choose your healthcare provider, participate in decisions about your treatment, and refuse or discontinue services at any time. You may also request information about alternative treatment approaches or referrals to other providers.

Appointments

Sessions are 50 minutes long and are offered in person at my Sellwood office in Portland, Oregon or through telehealth. Appointment frequency will be determined collaboratively based on your needs and availability.

Fees and Payment

My standard fee is $185 per 50-minute psychotherapy session, including the initial appointment. Additional information about fees, payment responsibilities, insurance billing, and cancellation policies is provided in my Financial and Insurance Agreement.

Cancellation and Missed Appointments

Please provide at least 24 hours' notice to cancel or reschedule an appointment. Late

cancellations and missed appointments are subject to a $180 fee, with a one-time exception for the first occurrence. Fees are subject to applicable legal and insurance restrictions. Additional details are provided in my Financial and Insurance Agreement.

Confidentiality
Information shared during psychotherapy is confidential, with exceptions permitted or required by law, including certain situations involving abuse or neglect, safety concerns, legal proceedings, and treatment or healthcare operations. I may also consult with other professionals to support your care while protecting your privacy. Additional information about confidentiality and your rights is provided in my Notice of Privacy Practices.

Couples and Family Psychotherapy
When working with couples or families affected by medical conditions, we will clarify treatment goals, who is considered the client, confidentiality expectations, and how individual disclosures and requests for records will be handled.

Communication Between Sessions
Email may be used for scheduling, billing, and other administrative matters. Because ordinary email may involve privacy risks, I encourage you to reserve sensitive clinical concerns for our scheduled appointments. Email is not intended for psychotherapy or urgent clinical concerns. I generally respond to nonurgent messages within two business days. Messages are not monitored continuously, including during evenings, weekends, and holidays.

Social Media and Professional Boundaries
To protect your privacy and maintain professional boundaries, I do not communicate with clients through social media or accept connection requests. Please use email for administrative communication.

Emergencies
My practice does not provide emergency or crisis services, and I cannot guarantee immediate availability between appointments. If you are experiencing an immediate emergency, call 911 or go to the nearest emergency department. For mental health crisis support, you may call or text 988. If your clinical needs require more intensive or immediate services than my practice can provide, we will discuss appropriate treatment options or referrals.

Telehealth Services
Telehealth appointments are conducted through Doxy.me, a secure video platform designed for healthcare services. You can access my virtual waiting room at:

https://doxy.me/drkateshirley

At your scheduled appointment time, simply open the link using your computer, tablet, or smartphone. No account or software download is required.

Telehealth may provide greater convenience and accessibility, but it also carries potential limitations, including technical difficulties, interruptions, privacy risks, and reduced ability to respond directly during emergencies.

You are encouraged to attend telehealth sessions from a private, quiet location where others cannot overhear our conversation. At the beginning of telehealth appointments, I will confirm your physical location and a means of contacting you in case of emergency or technical interruption. If a technical interruption occurs during a telehealth appointment, I will attempt to reconnect through the video platform or contact you using the telephone number you have provided. Telehealth services can only be provided when you are physically located in a jurisdiction where I am legally authorized to practice (i.e., Oregon and Washington).

Participation in telehealth is voluntary. You may discuss alternatives to telehealth, including in-person services, and may withdraw your consent to telehealth at any time. If telehealth is no longer appropriate or feasible, we will discuss alternative arrangements or referrals.

Clinical Records
I maintain confidential clinical records documenting assessment, treatment, and progress. Records are stored electronically using systems and safeguards intended to protect your information. You have rights regarding access to your records, requests for corrections, and other matters described in my Notice of Privacy Practices. Audio or video recording of sessions requires prior agreement. I do not record psychotherapy sessions.

Coordination of Care
When helpful, I may coordinate with other healthcare professionals involved in your care. I will obtain your authorization when required before sharing information.

Ending Therapy
You may discontinue psychotherapy at any time. When possible, I encourage discussing this decision so we can review your progress and consider additional resources. If I determine that another provider or level of care would better meet your needs, I will discuss this with you and make reasonable efforts to support an appropriate transition.

Questions or Concerns About Professional Services
I encourage you to discuss any questions or concerns about my services directly with me. You also have the right to contact the appropriate state licensing authority to ask questions or file a complaint. You may contact either licensing authority as appropriate without first discussing your concerns with me.

> **Oregon Board of Psychology**: https://www.oregon.gov/psychology
>
> **Washington Department of Health:** https://doh.wa.gov/licenses-permits-and-certificates/file-complaint-about-provider-or-facility

Consent for Treatment

By electronically signing, I acknowledge that:

- I have reviewed this agreement and understand the general nature, potential benefits, and risks of psychotherapy.
- I understand the policies regarding appointments, cancellations, communication, confidentiality, and emergencies.
- I understand the potential benefits, risks, and limitations of telehealth and consent to receiving services through telehealth when applicable.
- I have had the opportunity to ask questions.
- I voluntarily consent to receive psychological services from Dr. Kate Shirley.